



Will Claude's AI finance agents change your life?

May 6, 2026

Finance professionals may be quaking in their gilets today after Anthropic's latest release of Claude agents for financial services. But their alarm may be premature.

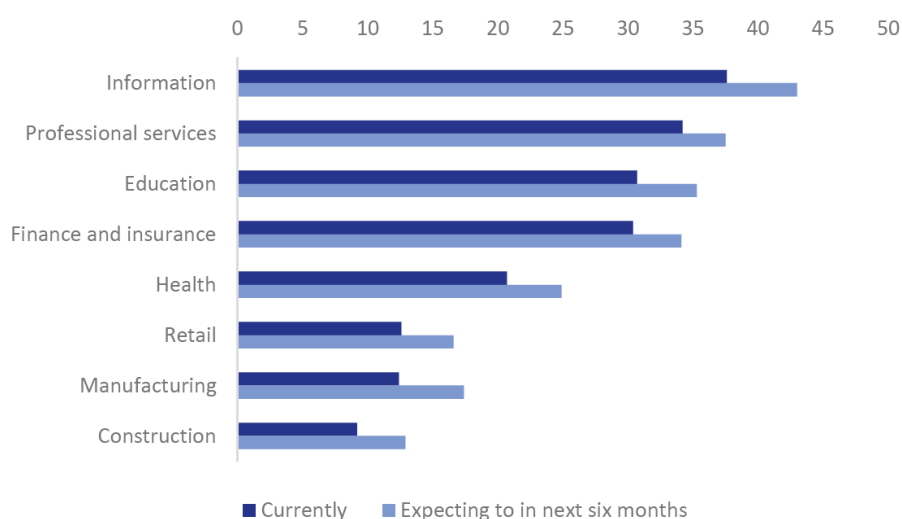
Anthropic [released](#) 10 "ready-to-run" agent templates yesterday to handle time-consuming tasks from research and client coverage to finance and operations with a webinar that included CEO Dario Amodei and JPMorgan CEO Jamie Dimon.

The templates bundle together skills, connectors (third-party market and research data) and sub-agents to help bankers build pitchbooks and models, screen KYC files, close month-end accounts and more.

While the internet was full of (AI-generated) memes of young bankers in tears this morning, the reality is that they are likely to continue to be working late nights and weekends to serve their clients for some time to come.

On the one hand, finance is the perfect industry for AI. It has abundant data; high-value, repeatable decisions often performed with manual processes; and operates in a digital, low-friction environment. US Census Bureau data shows that 30 percent of US banks and insurers were using AI in February and about 34 percent are expecting to use it in the next six months. That puts it not far behind information technology, the front-runner at 38 percent and 43 percent.

Figure 1: US companies using or expecting to use AI (% , Feb 2026)



Source: US Census Bureau, Deutsche Bank Research

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But on the other hand, adoption is easier said than done, particularly among the largest organisations operating in a highly regulated industry where 99 percent accurate is not accurate enough.

Barriers to adoption include:

1. **Technology and data:** the barriers to any new tech adoption include complex integration with legacy systems; the need for tailored, secure, high-quality – and accessible – data; and issues like data privacy and cybersecurity.
2. **Governance:** barriers specific to AI include the need for heightened guardrails around hallucination, bias, intellectual property and aligning stakeholders. There is also regulatory uncertainty as policymakers take differing and rapidly evolving approaches. AI activities must not only be understood but also explainable.
3. **People:** organisations need to rely on a limited pool of technology experts experienced in implementing a fast-evolving technology. They also must deal with a wide range of capabilities – and support or resistance – from managers and employees. At the very least, that requires training and cultural change.
4. **Customers and clients:** it is far from a given that customers and clients will be universally supportive of having their financial affairs handled by AI or dealing directly with AI agents, let alone giving enough data to the systems to make them valuable.

Diffusion is "much slower than the technology is capable of"

Amodei acknowledged the so-called capability overhang in the webinar, saying: "Our ability to commercialise this technology... is held back not by the power of the models and the economic value you can generate in principle but by the diffusion in the workplace... Diffusion is faster than we've seen in any technology previously in the world but it's still much slower than the technology itself is capable of."

Anthropic and its rival OpenAI are seeking to increase adoption by creating teams to help enterprises adopt AI – a crucial step in monetising the technology and paying for the rapid increase in demand for compute – not least to service the all-but-free service available to consumers.

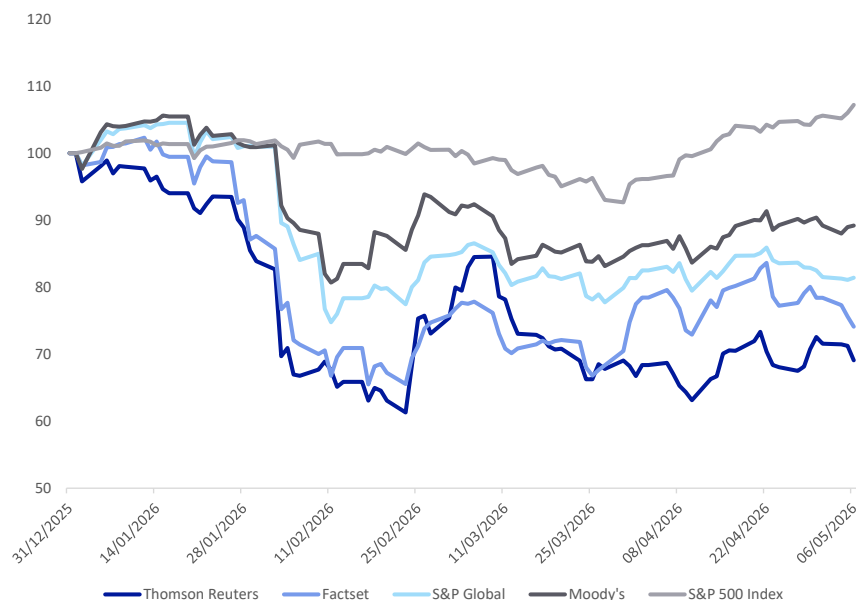
On Monday, Anthropic announced a joint venture focusing on deploying enterprise services, backed by companies including Blackstone, Hellman & Friedman and Goldman Sachs. On the same day, OpenAI was reported to be raising funds for a similar venture called The Development Company.

The ventures will reportedly raise money from the alternative asset managers in return for sales access to their investors' portfolio companies. It echoes the "forward-deployed engineer" model pioneered by Palantir, where engineers are embedded directly within client teams.

The news has had knock-on effects in data industry stocks, including Thomson Reuters and Factset. They had already been dented by the "SaaSocalypse" earlier this year, when the launch of Anthropic's Cowork led investors to question whether AI agents would disintermediate providers of traditional subscription software – or give them an opportunity by deploying AI themselves or being the golden source for leading AI providers.



Figure 2: Data providers and S&P 500 Index share price YTD, indexed to 100



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Research

Two life-changing scenarios?

Despite the challenges of adoption, there is no doubt that life for junior bankers in particular will change over time.

Anthropic described two scenarios.

In one, a natural resources group banker responds to a client who is considering taking their company private by forwarding a message to Claude using voice mode and Cowork Dispatch messenger. The tool then runs a pitch builder, including comps (comparable company) analysis, drawing in information from third-parties such as Standard & Poor's and Factset; creates an adjustable spreadsheet and an interactive slide deck; and prepares a draft to mail to the client.

In another scenario, a fund accountant uses a valuation review agent to pull tailored quarterly financial information before handing over to a statement auditor agent and then to a client.

The finance agents are available as plugins for users of Claude Cowork – which executes multi-step office tasks on a user's behalf – and Claude Code – an AI-powered coding assistant – running alongside Microsoft Excel, Powerpoint, Word and (soon) Outlook.

They are also available as a so-called cookbook for Claude Managed Agents, running autonomously on the Claude Platform for more in-depth work. They run best on Claude's latest Opus 4.7 model, Anthropic said. OpenAI and Google offer their own AI finance tools to perform some of the same tasks.

Three levels of adoption

Longer term, there are likely to be three levels of adoption of AI in financial services, with the first and parts of the second well-advanced, but the third still nascent:



1. **Individual productivity augmented:** tools like Cowork and Microsoft 365 Copilot.
2. **Processes automated:** streamlining operations and increasing efficiency, notably in back-office functions. Tasks like triaging incoming emails, and processes like onboarding, credit scoring and claims processing, may be among those that can be enhanced.
3. **Systems transformed:** building on AI platforms to create new workflows, rather than automating parts of existing workflows, and creating new revenue streams and business models. This may include autonomous agents running areas like trading and operations end-to-end; 24/7 market monitoring, client service and trade execution; and agents using multimodal data to update in real time.

Some areas are likely to remain elusive for longer still. Handing the keys to AI to trade the markets, the Holy Grail of capabilities, continues to be risky. Bloomberg reported today on a series of trading contests including one on [Alpha Arena](#), run by Nof1, where a portfolio run by eight major frontier systems lost about a third of its capital in two weeks.

Obstacles to extracting AI value

Getting the most out of the remarkable capabilities of AI will take time and depends on factors including:

1. **Adoption:** as mentioned above, only about a third of US finance companies are using AI in their business functions.
2. **Intensity:** most AI users still only dabble, with only 12 percent using it daily, according to St Louis Fed survey data.
3. **Suitability:** most jobs are a bundle of tasks, with some studies suggesting only one fifth of all US tasks can be performed by AI.
4. **Economic threshold:** even where tasks can be performed by AI at all, it may still be cheaper for humans to do them. Two years ago, admittedly a lifetime in AI terms, Nobel Prize-winning economist Daron Acemoglu's [Simple Macroeconomics of AI](#) paper cited data suggesting only a quarter of AI-labile tasks would be able to be automated.
5. **Overall cost:** while the capabilities of AI are increasing by the day, so is the cost of using more and more (albeit cheaper) tokens to execute more and more complex operations. At some point, companies will need to rein in token use and consolidate rather than letting every high-rolling employee develop an army of their own agents.

(These still low levels of deployment suggest that there could be significant latent demand justifying US hyperscaler capital expenditure on data centres reaching \$725bn this year. Shares in AMD, the No. 2 AI chipmaker, some way behind Nvidia, surged as much as 21 percent today after it boosted its sales forecast for the second quarter and said the market for generalist Central Processing Unit (GPU) chips will grow at greater than 35 percent a year to reach over \$120bn by 2030.)

What about us?

Humans still have a lot to offer. Beyond physical dexterity, most finance professionals will have an edge in qualities that clients are likely to want to pay for in the future:



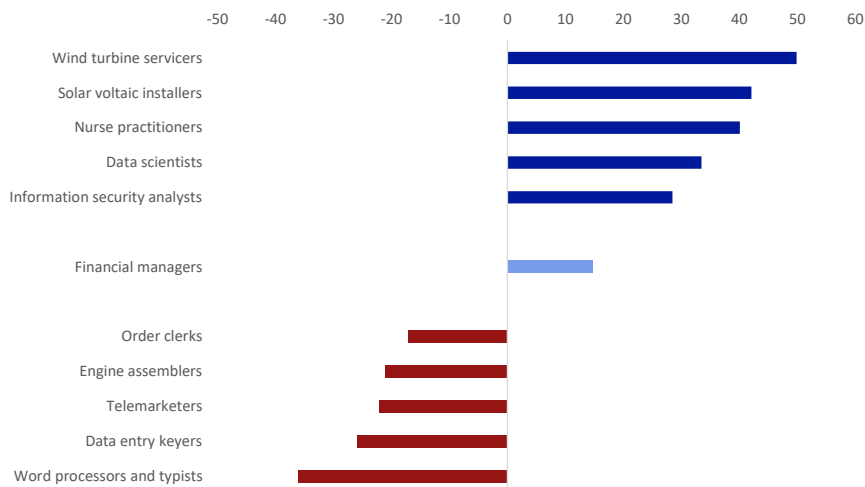
1. **Judgement** in defining problems and assessing outcomes, particularly unusual and risky edge cases;
2. **Genuine creativity**, rather than safe, centre-of-the-bell-curve amalgamations of what has gone before;
3. **Emotional intelligence**, including rapport, common sense and ethics.

An open question is how humans can develop these qualities if AI takes away much of the early-career grunt work where they are forged.

AI agents can boost those qualities while outperforming on aspects they do better and faster: analysing vast amounts of data; generating content; and executing tedious multi-step processes, with lower operational risk, an auditable workflow and humans in the loop only where necessary.

Consequently, the US Bureau of Labor Statistics predicts that financial managers will see a 15 percent increase in numbers over the coming decade.

Figure 3: Fastest growing and (selected) fastest declining occupations in US, 2024 to projected 2034 (% change)



Source : US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Deutsche Bank Research

That puts them among the winners in a list led by wind turbine servicers and solar voltaic installers, themselves benefitting from the need for energy to power the mushrooming of data centres. After nurse practitioners, another two occupations are also likely to be direct beneficiaries of AI: data scientists and information security analysts.

The larger of the fastest declining occupations will include word processors and typists, down by more than one third, the Bureau predicts, as well as data entry keyers, both performing tasks squarely in the sights of AI agents.



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